

Visual Studio Code Extension

DocsForge provides a VS Code extension for writing, previewing, and building documentation without leaving your editor.

Installation

From GitHub Releases (Recommended)

1. Download the latest `.vsix` file from the [GitHub Releases page](#)
2. In VS Code, open **Extensions** (`Ctrl+Shift+X`)
3. Click the ... (More Actions) menu → **Install from VSIX...**
4. Select the downloaded `.vsix` file

From VSIX (Manual)

```
# Install via command line
code --install-extension docsforge-vscode-*.vsix
```

Prerequisites

- **VS Code 1.99+**
- **Python 3.10+** with `docsforge` installed:

```
pip install docsforge
```

Getting Started

1. Open a DocsForge project

Open a folder containing a `docsforge.yml` file. The extension activates automatically and prompts:

```
"DocsForge project detected. Start dev server?"
```

Select **"Yes"** to start the dev server immediately, or use the sidebar later.

2. Create a new project

If you don't have a project yet:

1. Click the **DocsForge icon** in the activity bar (left sidebar)
2. Click **Initialize Project**
3. Follow the wizard: site name, description, theme color, language, privacy mode, etc.
4. The project is created in your workspace root

Features

Sidebar Actions

The DocsForge sidebar appears in the activity bar and shows contextual actions:

Action	When	What it does
Start Server	Server stopped	Starts <code>docsforge serve --no-open</code> in the workspace
Stop Server	Server running	Stops the running dev server
Build	Always	Runs <code>docsforge build</code> and shows output in the channel
Open Preview	Server running	Opens the site in VS Code's built-in browser
Initialize Project	Always	Creates a new DocsForge project interactively

Status Bar

The status bar shows the current server state:

- ► **DocsForge: stopped** — Click to start the server
- ► **DocsForge: starting...** — Server is starting up
- ► **DocsForge: http://localhost:8000** — Server is running. Click to open preview

Dev Server

The extension runs `docsforge serve --no-open` in the background:

- Output streams to the **DocsForge** output channel (`Ctrl+Shift+U` → select "DocsForge")
- A progress notification shows "Starting DocsForge server..." until the URL is detected
- When the server is ready, the URL appears in the status bar
- VS Code's built-in browser handles navigation and hot-reload

Preview

Click **Open Preview** to see your site in VS Code's Simple Browser. This is VS Code's Electron-based browser — it supports all feature navigation, search, and page transitions.

Build

Click **Build** to run `docsforge build`. Output streams to the DocsForge channel. A notification shows the result.

Configuration

Settings

Setting	Default	Description
<code>docsforge.pythonPath</code>	<code>"python"</code>	Python interpreter path. Use <code>"python3"</code> on systems where <code>python</code> isn't Python 3
<code>docsforge.lan</code>	<code>false</code>	Serve on all interfaces (<code>0.0.0.0</code>) instead of localhost only
<code>docsforge.openBrowser</code>	<code>true</code>	Open the site in VS Code's Simple Browser when the server starts

Example: Configuring Python Path

If you use a virtual environment or a non-default Python:

```
{  
  "docsforge.pythonPath": "/home/user/.venv/bin/python"  
}
```

Or via `.vscode/settings.json` in your project:

```
{  
  "docsforge.pythonPath": ".venv/bin/python"  
}
```

Workflows

Edit → Preview Loop

1. **Start Server** from the sidebar
2. Click **Open Preview** when it's ready
3. Edit your Markdown files
4. The preview auto-reloads on save
5. **Stop Server** when done

Build → Deploy

1. **Build** from the sidebar
2. Check the output for any errors
3. The built site is in `site/` — deploy anywhere

Initialize → Develop → Deploy

1. **Initialize Project** — creates the project structure
2. **Start Server** — preview and iterate
3. **Build** — production build
4. Deploy `site/` to your hosting platform

Troubleshooting

Issue	Fix
"Failed to run python"	Set <code>docsforge.pythonPath</code> to the correct Python binary
"No docsforge.yml found"	Run Initialize Project first, or create a <code>docsforge.yml</code> manually

Issue	Fix
Preview shows blank page	Check the DevTools console in VS Code (<code>Help</code> → <code>Toggle Developer Tools</code>)
Server won't start	Open the DocsForge output channel (<code>Ctrl+Shift+U</code>) for error details
"python: command not found"	Install Python 3.10+ from python.org

Commands

All available commands (accessible via `Ctrl+Shift+P`):

Command	Description
<code>DocsForge: Initialize Project</code>	Create a new docsforge project
<code>DocsForge: Start Dev Server</code>	Start the development server
<code>DocsForge: Stop Dev Server</code>	Stop the development server
<code>DocsForge: Build</code>	Build the documentation
<code>DocsForge: Open in VS Code Browser</code>	Open the preview
<code>DocsForge: Refresh</code>	Refresh the sidebar

Quick Install

macOS / Linux:

```
curl -fsSL
https://raw.githubusercontent.com/QQSHI13/docsforge/main/scripts/install.sh |
bash
```

Windows (PowerShell):

```
irm
https://raw.githubusercontent.com/QQSHI13/docsforge/main/scripts/install.ps1 |
```

iex

From GitHub Releases

Download the latest `.vsix` from the [GitHub Releases page](#), then:

Extensions → ... → Install from VSIX... → select the file

Prerequisites

Check the [GitHub Releases](#) for new versions. The release includes both the Python package and the `.vsix` file. Extension version matches the main package version.

Next Steps

- [Usage Guide](#) — Day-to-day DocsForge usage
- [Deployment Guide](#) — Deploy your site after building
- [Features](#) — All core features

 Jun 19, 2026  Jun 19, 2026